

SUBSPACE.MONEY

PRODUCT TEARDOWN · MAY 2026

Product Teardown

5 Non-Obvious Feedbacks Across UX, Features,
GTM & Competitor Strategy

CANDIDATE

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ROLE

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SUBMISSION DATE

May 31, 2026

COMPANY CHOSEN

Subspace.money

RESEARCH METHOD

Direct app usage + competitive analysis + market data + Play Store reviews

Company Research

What is Subspace.money?

Subspace.money is India's first AI-native savings and subscription marketplace, founded February 2022 by IIT Madras alumni Mritunjoy Das (Joey Dash) and Rag Sanil. Built without a rupee of external funding, Subspace today does Rs. 36.5 Crore in ARR with just 3 employees — through 90% AI-powered operations, a proprietary Negotiate API, and a group subscription-sharing model that lets Indian users save up to 80% on OTT, SaaS, and digital tools.

Rs.36.5 Cr ARR (FY25)	Bootstrapped & Profitable	3 Employees	90% AI-Powered Ops	#1 India Savings App (Play Store)	2022 Founded IIT Madras
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Product Pillars

CORE	Subscriptions Group-sharing marketplace for OTT, SaaS, and productivity tools. Netflix, YouTube Premium, Canva, Microsoft 365 and 100+ more — shared at up to 80% off retail. Powered by the proprietary Negotiate API that automates price discovery with brands.
NEWER	Rentals Physical product rental with 10-minute delivery in select cities. Gadgets, accessories, and everyday essentials on demand. Applies the sharing-economy model to physical assets — unique in the Indian market.
MONETIZATION	Gift Cards 200+ brands (Swiggy, Zomato, Amazon, Flipkart, Myntra, Blinkit and more) at 3–13% discount. High-margin, low-support SKUs that compound the platform's savings value proposition.

Market Context

India's OTT market was valued at USD 5.4 Billion in 2025, projected to reach USD 28.1 Billion by 2034 (CAGR 19%). India has over 900 million internet users entering the subscription economy, with UPI autopay making recurring payments frictionless and harder to cancel. Netflix has extended its password-sharing crackdown to India — the same policy that drove 7.6 million new global subscribers. This directly validates Subspace's thesis: as informal sharing becomes harder, a structured, compliant group-sharing platform becomes the natural alternative for cost-conscious Indian consumers.

Competitive Landscape

Subspace's direct competitive set in India is thin. Its top competitors per Tracxn are myPaisaa, MoneyClub (TMC), and Finlok — all significantly smaller in ARR, user base, and product completeness. Subspace ranks #1 among 7 active competitors in its category.

Company	Core Offering	Funding	Key Gap vs Subspace
Subspace.money	Subscriptions + Rentals + Gift Cards + Negotiate API	Bootstrapped Rs.36.5 Cr ARR	— (Benchmark)
myPaisaa	Subscription tracker + bill reminders	Undisclosed	No group sharing, no marketplace, no rentals
MoneyClub (TMC)	Group savings / chit fund model	Funded (Mar 2025)	Finance-first, not subscription-focused
Finlok	Bill splitting + expense tracking	Undisclosed	No OTT marketplace, no Negotiate API
CRED	Credit card rewards + bill pay	Well-funded	Premium user base, no subscription sharing
Rocket Money (US)	Subscription mgmt + cancellation	Acquired by Rocket	US-only, no group sharing, no India ops

The Structural Moat

What Subspace has that no competitor replicates: the Negotiate API — an automated price negotiation layer that plugs into brand APIs and extracts the best rate on behalf of the user. Building this requires direct brand relationships, years of price elasticity data, and significant engineering investment. They have all three. The group-sharing mechanic also has genuine network effects: more admins → more groups → more savings → more members. The key competitive risk is not from existing Indian startups — it's from PhonePe, Paytm, or Google Pay adding subscription management to their existing fintech apps. The Negotiate API and community trust layer are the only real defence against that scenario.

App Analysis: Evidence from Direct Usage

The following analysis is based on direct usage of the Subspace Android app. Screenshots were captured across the full user journey: onboarding, home, explore, wallet, chat, and account. Every feedback in Section 04 traces directly to specific screens documented below.

Home Screen — First Launch (Cold User)

Shows "Good evening User" — name is "User" because onboarding captured nothing. A large credit card upsell card dominates the screen before the user has any subscriptions or history. Directly below: "No Active Subscriptions." High-trust ask before any value delivery. The sequencing is inverted.

Explore — Shared Subscriptions (149+ Netflix Groups)

Netflix shows 149+ groups at Rs.163/device. Every group card shows identical metadata: sharing count, duration, price. Zero differentiation between a reliable admin and one who has ghosted members. No admin score, no last-active, no renewal rate.

Explore — Gift Cards & Favourite Brands

Hero banner: Google Play gift card at 3% OFF. Favourite Brands: Swiggy 3%, Amazon 4%, SonyLiv 48%, Zomato 6%, ZEE5 50%. The 3% banner is the loudest visual on the screen while 48–50% discounts are less prominent — weak merchandising hierarchy.

Account Tab — 13 Undifferentiated Menu Items

A flat list of 13 items with no grouping: App Settings, Payout Methods, Friends, Blogs and Articles, AI Powered Mailbox, Money Saved, Refer & Earn, KYC Verification, App Info, Help & Support, Review Us. Critical actions (KYC, Payout) buried alongside tertiary items like "Blogs and Articles."

Chat Tab — Anonymous Messaging in a Fintech App

The Messages screen has four filter tabs: All, Group, Private, and Anonymous. No explanation of what Anonymous chat means or why it exists in a fintech context where users transact real money with strangers.

Profile — Empty Identity After Onboarding

Full Name: "User". Username: Not set. Email: Not set. Only phone number captured. A platform whose group-sharing model depends on admin accountability and member trust has no identity infrastructure. Direct root cause of trust failures.

The 5 Feedbacks

Each feedback is structured as: Observed (specific screen/flow/copy seen in the app), Evidence & Analysis (why it matters — the real user or business pain, backed by data and competitive context), and Ship Instead (specific, actionable solution with implementation path). The 5 feedbacks span 4 pillars: UX (×2), Features, GTM, and Competitor Analysis.

01

UX

Onboarding Captures No Identity — The Platform Calls Every New User "User"

OBSERVED

After completing signup, the Profile screen shows: Full Name — "User", Username — "Not set", Email — "Not set". The Home screen greets every new user with "Good evening User." The onboarding flow accepted a phone number and location — and considered setup complete. No name, no email, no intent question.

EVIDENCE & ANALYSIS

Subspace's entire value proposition depends on trust between strangers. Group subscription sharing requires members to trust the admin will share credentials and not disappear. Admins need to trust members will pay. Rentals require addresses and accountability. Every transaction requires identity — and the platform has none. Play Store reviews document the consequences: March 2026 review: "had problems with shared subscription as admin never replied." April 2026: "Groups will not be listed all of a sudden." These are not bugs — they are trust failures from an identity-free design. Deloitte 2025 found 38% of new customers leave mid-onboarding if it takes too long — but Subspace avoids drop-off by asking nothing, and in doing so sacrifices the trust infrastructure the product needs to function at scale.

SHIP INSTEAD

Replace with 3-step progressive onboarding: Step 1 — Phone OTP (already done). Step 2 — First name + avatar pick (30 seconds). Step 3 — Single intent question: "What brings you to Subspace?" [Save on OTT / Share with friends / Rent / Explore deals]. Route immediately to the relevant surface. The name feeds trust infrastructure: admin profiles become identifiable, the home screen becomes personal. The intent answer drives merchandising — a user who selects "Save on OTT" sees shared subscriptions first, not a gift card banner.

OBSERVED

The Shared Subscriptions list shows Netflix at Rs.163/device with "149+ groups." JioHotstar 42+ groups, Prime Video 36+ groups. Every group card shows identical metadata: sharing count, duration, price per device. No admin rating, no renewal rate, no "last active" timestamp, no dispute history. All 149 Netflix groups are visually and informationally identical.

EVIDENCE & ANALYSIS

The group-sharing model is structurally a two-sided marketplace where admins hold disproportionate power. The current UI gives members zero information to make a trust-based decision — they are choosing a financial counterparty with only a price to go on. This creates two simultaneous market failures. First, adverse selection: without a trust signal, users default to price — rewarding cheapest admins, not most reliable. Second, good admin under-investment: admins who have built a strong track record have no mechanism to signal it and cannot charge a reliability premium. Play Store data validates this: reviews consistently cite admin responsiveness as the #1 dissatisfaction source. Airbnb solved the identical problem in 2012 with two-way ratings. Uber solved it with driver scores. Subspace's marketplace operates without the trust infrastructure that every successful two-sided platform has built.

SHIP INSTEAD

Launch an Admin Trust Score visible on every group card. Inputs: renewal rate, average response time, dispute rate, total successful transactions, account age. Display: 5-star rating or tiered badge (New / Verified / Trusted / Top Admin). Add "Last active: 2 hours ago" to each group card. Start with transaction data already in the system. Build the score backend first — no UI change needed initially. Surface it as a badge in the second iteration. Introduce "Top Admin" tier with a revenue-share boost (15% instead of standard 10%) to incentivize quality. Creates a flywheel: better admins attract more members, earn more, promote the platform organically.

Credit Card Upsell Served to Cold Users Before the Product Has Done Anything for Them

OBSERVED

Home screen on first launch shows a prominent card: "Add your credit card & get personalized offers — We'll analyze your spending and suggest the best cashback & rewards for you." This appears before the user has added any subscription, completed any transaction, or experienced any value. Directly below: "No Active Subscriptions." The user has been on the app for 60 seconds.

EVIDENCE & ANALYSIS

This is a trust-timing mismatch. The credit card CTA asks for high-sensitivity financial data at the point of minimum user trust. The ICP for this feature is a returning user who has saved money and experienced the product's value — not a cold user at T=0 seconds. 2026 fintech UX research is unambiguous: "The biggest onboarding UX mistake isn't too many steps — it's asking for trust before earning it." The principle of progressive disclosure — earn the right to ask for more data by delivering value first — is standard practice at Stripe, Revolut, and CRED. Subspace's core ICP is cost-conscious 18–35 year-olds who are digitally savvy and alert to data asks. Showing "give us your credit card" before the product has done anything for them undermines platform trust and likely drives significant Day-1 churn.

SHIP INSTEAD

Gate the credit card CTA behind a "first value milestone." Trigger only after: (a) user joins a shared subscription group, (b) purchases a gift card, or (c) saves a verifiable amount above Rs.100. Change the copy at the moment of maximum trust — Current: "Add your credit card & get personalized offers" → Proposed: "You saved Rs.X this month. Connect your card — we'll find you Rs.Y more." Same feature, same business goal — served at the moment when the user has experienced value and the ask feels like a natural extension of the product rather than a data grab. Expected outcome: significantly higher CTA conversion and lower Day-1 uninstall rate.

OBSERVED

The Explore page lists Google Gemini Pro at Rs.325/device with 14+ groups. ChatGPT Plus, Claude Pro, Perplexity Pro, Midjourney, and Notion AI are not listed anywhere. The productivity catalogue includes Microsoft Office, Canva, and VPNs — but misses the entire AI tools category except Gemini, which has thin group density (14 groups vs Netflix's 149).

EVIDENCE & ANALYSIS

AI tool subscriptions are the fastest-growing recurring expense for India's 18–35 demographic — exactly Subspace's core ICP. In Q1 2026, ChatGPT from OpenAI was among India's top revenue-generating apps (alongside YouTube and Google One). ChatGPT Plus costs ~Rs.1,700/month. Perplexity Pro ~Rs.1,400/month. Midjourney ~Rs.830/month. These are dollar-denominated and actively painful for Indian users. No Indian platform currently offers structured group sharing for AI tools. The global analogs (Splitguru, SubShare) are US-focused. This is a genuine first-mover window. The savings math is the most dramatic on the platform: ChatGPT Plus shared across 5 users via OpenAI Teams = Rs.425/device vs Rs.1,700 solo — a 75% saving. No OTT subscription on Subspace achieves this savings percentage.

SHIP INSTEAD

Launch a dedicated "AI Tools" section in Explore. Initial catalogue: ChatGPT Plus (OpenAI Teams — 5 users), Perplexity Pro, Midjourney, Notion AI, Google One AI Premium. Lead with savings math: "ChatGPT Plus: Rs.1,700/month solo → Rs.425/device shared." Feature on Home screen banner rotation. GTM play: Partner with college tech communities and startup ecosystems — exactly where Subspace's ICP spends time. A single viral message — "Share ChatGPT with 4 friends for Rs.425/month on Subspace" — has organic reach that no OTT saving achieves. First-mover window is now.

OBSERVED

The Account tab contains 13 flat menu items in a single undivided list with no sections or grouping: Profile, Add Address, Rental History, Order History, App Settings, Payout Methods, Friends, Blogs and Articles, AI Powered Mailbox, Money Saved, Refer & Earn, KYC Verification, App Info, Help & Support, Review Us. The Chat tab additionally shows an "Anonymous" filter tab with no explanation in a fintech context.

EVIDENCE & ANALYSIS

The Account tab is doing three distinct jobs simultaneously: identity management (Profile, KYC, Address), financial management (Payout, Money Saved, Order History), and social/discovery (Friends, Mailbox, Blogs, Refer & Earn). Mixing these in a flat list creates cognitive overload and buries the two most critical actions on the entire platform. KYC completion and Payout setup are the actions that unlock Subspace's real utility — without KYC, users cannot withdraw earnings; without Payout setup, admins cannot collect revenue. Both are buried in a 13-item list alongside "Blogs and Articles" and "Review Us." This structurally suppresses KYC completion rate and directly reduces active earning admins on the platform.

SHIP INSTEAD

Restructure Account into three labelled sections: "My Profile" — Profile, KYC Verification, Add Address. "My Money" — Wallet, Payout Methods, Order History, Rental History, Money Saved. "Community" — Friends, Refer & Earn, AI Powered Mailbox. Promote KYC and Payout as inline progress cards at the top of Account: "Complete KYC to unlock withdrawals" and "Add Payout Method to earn as an admin" — both shown as progress bars with clear completion status, not buried list items. Remove "Blogs and Articles", "App Info", and "Review Us" from primary Account menu. Move to App Settings or a footer link. Remove or contextualise Anonymous chat — if it serves a real use case, explain it; if not, remove it.

Prioritization & Impact Assessment

The 5 feedbacks are ordered by user impact (how many users are affected, how often), business impact (direct effect on core KPIs), and implementation effort (complexity of the solution). The matrix below maps each feedback across these dimensions.

#	Feedback	Pillar	Users Affected	Business KPI	Effort	Priority
01	Identity-free onboarding	UX	100% — every user	D30 retention, trust	Low	P0 — Critical
02	No Admin Trust Score	Features	~80% group users	Churn, GMV	Medium	P1 — High
03	Credit card upsell timing	GTM	100% — new users	Conversion, trust	Low	P1 — High
04	AI Tools category gap	Competitor	18–35 ICP	Revenue, growth	Medium	P2 — Growth
05	Account IA overload	UX	All users	KYC rate, payout	Low	P2 — Medium

Tradeoff Thinking

Feedback 01 (onboarding) adds ~30 seconds of friction to signup — marginal higher initial drop-off vs significantly higher Day-30 retention. The data strongly favours the latter. Feedback 02 (Admin Trust Score) requires surfacing negative data about some admins, which may reduce group joins short-term — the tradeoff is short-term GMV reduction vs long-term platform trust and admin quality. Feedback 04 (AI Tools) requires new brand partnerships and potentially new legal structures for OpenAI Teams accounts — higher effort, but the first-mover advantage makes the timing critical. Feedbacks 03 and 05 are low-effort, high-signal changes that should be shipped first given the effort-to-impact ratio.

What Was Excluded (and Why)

Several observations were intentionally excluded: the "Locked Amount" vs "Unlocked Amount" terminology in the Wallet (unclear to new users but a copy issue, not a product flaw); the Rental "10 minutes" delivery promise shown alongside a user's real home address on the Home screen (a privacy signal worth flagging separately); and the "Sell Products (PREMIUM)" gate (a business model decision, not a product fault). These were excluded because the 5 chosen feedbacks represent systemic issues with higher business impact than UI polish.

Closing Assessment

Subspace is a genuinely unusual company. Rs.36.5 Crore in ARR, bootstrapped, profitable, 3 people, 90% AI-powered operations — this is the AI-native company thesis proven in production before most companies have figured out how to write the memo. The Negotiate API is a real moat. The group-sharing mechanic has genuine network effects. The multi-pillar platform addresses real consumer pain in a market where subscription fatigue is accelerating alongside subscription proliferation.

The feedbacks in this document are not critiques of what is broken — they are observations about what is almost right and what needs to be built next. The identity layer, the admin trust infrastructure, the credit card timing, the AI tools category, and the information architecture are all unlocks — each one compounds the value of what Subspace already has. The core product works. The next phase is making it trustworthy at scale.

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